

Alpha ex Machina Quick Reference

Your turn

1. **Refresh:** committed funding sources, talent, offices, and tools become available.
2. **Settle:** pay interest; collect office income and Yield (Surplus or cards; choose for Patent Portfolio); pay carrying costs in Surplus or discard the card (the total rounds down); next stage of each developing event.
3. **Draw 1.** A Forecastable card is shown to the table and can't be run this turn.
4. **Operate:** add 1 funding source (gain Margin); 1 staffing move (hire or open an office); buy tools; play investments, treaties, covers; run scenarios; use abilities.
5. **Close:** margin call (keep 1 Margin Credit per 10 Surplus); discard to 8; others may run 1 Breaking scenario each.

The first-player marker passes left every round. Opening hand: 6 cards, one redraw.

Money

- **Leverage:** commit a funding source for 1; committed cards are available again next turn (on paper, slide them forward); unspent Leverage is lost.
- **Surplus:** your capital. 0 or less $\Rightarrow$ insolvent.
- **Margin:** +1 Surplus per exposure on a funding source you add.
- **Hire:** pay Surplus. **Poach** (only cards that say so): Hire cost + 2 Surplus; not a staffing move; the poached employee gains Non-compete and arrives committed (gardening leave).
- **Price:** pay Surplus to buy a tool. Not a talent move; one of each; never poached or fired. Its exposures count like a funding source's.
- **Liquidate** any time: Sale value as Leverage or Surplus. Meme Stock waits until your next turn, even for forced sales.
- **Fire Sale:** after a sale by a company under 10 Surplus, everyone under 15 sells that investment for half its Sale value, rounded down.
- **Long vol:** when a Volatility scenario hits you, each VIX Calls or Long Straddle gains 10% of the table's loss.

Running a scenario

1. Pay Leverage; choose the target if needed. **Focus:** pay 2 more, pick one opponent, it loses double.
2. **Response window:** left of you first, you last. Responses, committed talent, offices, or tools, liquidation. No responses to responses.
3. **Stop:** the runner pays the extra Leverage the card names, or the scenario is called off. An Act of God can't be stopped.
4. **Resolve,** then check insolvency.

A free Bank Run (Emergency Equity Infusion) is run in full at once, never Focused; then the scenario it interrupted picks up again. Everything Is Securities Fraud: when the scenario ends, its target loses what scenarios have cost it this round, again.

Financials (banks and funds)

- **Retail Deposits:** Short-Term Rates exposure, except a third of them (rounded down), which have none; a bank run takes half, rounded down, counting Venture Deposits and Evergreen Credit with them.

- **Investor Capital:** Short-Term Equity exposure.
- **Private Credit:** no exposure; carrying cost $1\frac{1}{2}$.
- **Margin Credit:** no exposure; carrying cost 1; margin call at the end of your turn.
- **Loans** (Credit Cards, Mortgage Lending, Prime Brokerage) are investments with a Credit exposure.

Headquarters and offices

HQ starts free beside your CEO, outside the 40 cards, and stays. Pay **Open** in Surplus for a branch; it shares your staffing move. One of each city per company. No Leverage or recurring carrying costs. Offices cannot be poached or fired. Close a branch with no refund; never your HQ. **Fully Remote:** HQ only, no other offices. First-action bonuses do not refresh when an office opens. Commit prevention is a total across matching clauses.

Drawing and discarding

Extra draws come from funding sources you add, Responses you play, and investments or employees at the start of your turn. When a card makes you discard, you choose which cards, face up. An empty deck just stops drawing.

Who gets hit

Each opponent (not you; with Focus, one of them for double)
· **Target opponent** · **Systemic** (you too)

Loss math

Clause amount $\times$ (exposures $-$ hedges, min 0). **x2** counts twice. Nat Cat: Any matches every Nat Cat peril. Focused: double each clause.

Protection order: failed programs ("Destroyed if") $\rightarrow$ covers, ignores, flips $\rightarrow$ halving $\rightarrow$ flat reductions $\rightarrow$ swap payments $\rightarrow$ responses, talent, offices, and tools $\rightarrow$ XoL cap $\rightarrow$ recoveries.

Insolvency

Auto-sell liquid investments. Still at 0 or less: out. Too Big to Fail makes a failure cost everyone else 5 Surplus.

Decks and table size

Deck limits: 3 copies of a card; 1 of a **Signature** card; any number of a **Staple** card. **AI:** AI Bubble Bursts destroys it.

Players	2	3	4
Starting Surplus	16	18	25

Game ends after round 10: most Surplus wins.

Keywords

Forecastable shown when drawn or searched for, not runnable that turn. **Act of God** can't be stopped. **Breaking** runnable at the end of another player's turn. **Developing Event** stage 1 now, one more each turn; turn the card a quarter turn per stage. **Systemic** hits you too. **Focus** pay 2 more to hit one opponent for double; other effects once. **Illiquid** can't be sold. **Non-compete** can't be poached. **CEO** starts in play; never poached or fired. **Dark** evidence once in your discard pile; reckonings charge per piece, and only the Paper Shredder removes it.